Communication Skills

The big idea

Communication comes from the Latin word *communicare*, meaning "to share". It is the process of exchanging information, ideas and feelings so that the other person understands them. Whether you are greeting a teacher, answering a phone call or writing an e-mail, the way you communicate shapes how people see you.

THE COMMUNICATION CYCLE

Sender (has an idea) → **Message** → **Channel** (speech, letter, e-mail, phone) → **Receiver** → **Feedback**. Without feedback, the sender cannot be sure the message was understood.

Elements of communication

- **Sender** – the person who starts the communication.
- **Message** – the idea, information or feeling being shared.
- **Channel/medium** – the way it is sent (face to face, phone, letter, e-mail, video call).
- **Receiver** – the person who gets the message.
- **Feedback** – the receiver's response (a reply, a nod, a question).

Feedback should be **specific**, **timely**, **polite** and **helpful**. It can be **positive** ("Your project was well organised") or **negative/constructive** ("Next time add a conclusion").

Methods of communication

Method	Description	Examples
Verbal – oral	Spoken words	Talking, phone call, speech, video meeting
Verbal – written	Words in writing	Letters, e-mails, SMS, notices, reports
Non-verbal	Without words	Facial expressions, gestures, posture, eye contact, touch, personal space, tone of voice
Visual	Images and signs	Traffic signs, charts, maps, emojis, posters

READING BODY LANGUAGE

Smiling and nodding → interest and agreement. Arms crossed and looking away → disagreement or discomfort. Keep an open posture and steady eye contact when you speak.

SILENCE STILL COMMUNICATES

Not replying, or looking bored, sends a message too. Non-verbal signals should match your words.

Basic greetings and introductions

Greetings set the tone of any conversation.

- **Formal greetings** (teachers, elders, at work): "Good morning, Sir/Ma'am", "Namaste", "How do you do?".
- **Informal greetings** (friends, family): "Hi!", "Hello!", "What's up?".
- Time-based greetings: **Good morning** (till noon), **Good afternoon** (noon to about 5 pm), **Good evening** (after that). **Good night** is used only when leaving or going to bed, not as a greeting.

INTRODUCING YOURSELF

"Good morning, everyone. My name is Arjun Mehta. I study in Class 9 at Green Valley School. I enjoy coding and playing football. Thank you." Introducing others: "Ma'am, this is my friend Priya. She is the captain of our quiz team."

Pronunciation and speaking well

Speak clearly, at a moderate pace, with correct **pronunciation** (the way a word is spoken). Practise by listening to news readers, reading aloud and recording yourself. Use polite words: **please, thank you, sorry, excuse me**.

Writing basics

Writing needs correct **capitalisation** (first word of a sentence, names, "I"), **punctuation** (full stop, comma, question mark, apostrophe, exclamation mark) and the basic parts of speech. A good sentence has a **subject** and a **verb** (e.g. *Meera writes*).

EXAM TIP

In "write a self-introduction" questions, include greeting, name, class/school, interests and a closing line.

Quick recap

- Communication cycle: sender, message, channel, receiver, feedback.
- Methods: verbal (oral, written), non-verbal, visual.
- Formal vs informal greetings; good night is not a greeting.
- Speak clearly, use polite words, and use correct capitalisation and punctuation.

Practice questions

1. The word "communication" comes from the Latin word communicare, which means
   (a) to speak (b) to share (c) to write (d) to listen
2. A nod of the head while someone speaks is an example of
   (a) written communication (b) visual communication (c) non-verbal communication (d) oral communication
3. Which greeting is used when meeting a teacher at 3 pm?
   (a) Good morning (b) Good night (c) Hi dude (d) Good afternoon
4. Which of the following is NOT a part of the communication cycle?
   (a) Sender (b) Feedback (c) Channel (d) Password
5. A bar graph in a report is an example of
   (a) visual communication (b) oral communication (c) non-verbal gesture (d) informal greeting
6. Which is a formal greeting?
   (a) Hey, what's up? (b) Good morning, Ma'am (c) Yo! (d) Hi buddy
7. What is feedback? Give one example each of positive and negative (constructive) feedback.
8. Explain the three main methods of communication with two examples each.

Answers: 1. b 2. c 3. d 4. d 5. a 6. b 7. see notes 8. see notes